



CITY COUNCIL MEETING MINUTES

March 24, 2026

CALL TO ORDER:

The Jackson City Council met in regular session in Council Chambers and was called to order at 6:30 p.m. by Mayor Daniel J. Mahoney.

PLEDGE OF ALLEGIANCE AND INVOCATION:

Council joined in the Pledge of Allegiance. Invocation was given by Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt.

ROLL CALL:

Present: Mayor Daniel Mahoney, First Ward Councilmember Arlene Robinson, Vice Mayor/Second Ward Councilmember Freddie Dancy, Third Ward Councilmember Angelita Gunn, Fourth Ward Councilmember Conner Wood, Fifth Ward Councilmember Shalanda Hunt, and Sixth Ward Councilmember Will Forgrave.

Absent: none.

Also present: City Manager Jonathan Greene, City Attorney Matthew Hagerty, City Clerk Andrea Muray, Director of Parks and Recreation Kelli Hoover, Chief Equity Officer John Willis, Police Chief Chris Simpson, Director of Community Development Shane LaPorte, Director of Finance Heather Ehnis, and City Engineer Troy White.

ADOPTION OF AGENDA:

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt the agenda. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

PRESENTATIONS/PROCLAMATIONS: none.

PUBLIC HEARINGS: none.

CITIZEN COMMENTS:

Citizen comments were heard and the meeting continued.

CONSENT CALENDAR:

- A. Minutes — Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on March 10, 2026**
Approve the proposed meeting minutes from the Regular Meeting of the Jackson City Council on March 10, 2026.
- B. Resolution Honoring Pastor James L. Hines 38th Pastoral Anniversary – Lily Missionary Baptist Church**
Approve the resolution honoring Pastor James L. Hines' 38 years at Lily Missionary Baptist Church and, for the next year, honorably name Plymouth Street between East Avenue and Page Avenue to Pastor James L. Hines Drive and erect signs to display this honor for all to see.
- C. Appointment to the Human Relations Commission**
Approve the Mayor's recommendation to appoint Anne deIrala to the Human Relations Commission for a three-year term, beginning immediately and ending on December 31, 2028.
- D. Board and Commission Resignations**
Place on file the resignation(s) of David Hammontree (Election Commission), Anna Hand (Historic District Commission), and Derek Dobies (Board of Review).
- E. 2025 Community Police Oversight Commission Annual Report**
Receive and place on file.
- F. Special Event Application: Free Comic Book Day**
Approve a request from the GamePlace LLC to host the Free Comic Book Day on May 2, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- G. Special Event Application: 12th Annual Heart of a Lion 5k**
Approve a request from the Jackson Area 19 Special Olympics to host the 12 Annual Heart of a Lion 5k on August 23, 2026, at Ella Sharp Park.
- H. Special Event Application: Bark for Life**
Approve a request from the American Cancer Society to host the Bark for Life on May 3, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

- I. Special Event Application: Jackson High School Commencement Ceremony**
Approve a request from the McKibbin Media Group to host the Jackson High School Commencement Ceremony on May 22, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- J. Special Event Application: Bike Night**
Approve a request from Bella Notte Ristorante to host the Bike Night on Tuesdays, April - October 2026 in downtown Jackson.
- K. Special Event Application: No Kings Rally**
Approve a request from the Jackson County Democratic Committee to host the No Kings Rally on March 28, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- L. Special Event Application: Memorial Day Cascades Fireworks Show**
Approve a request from Jackson County Parks to host the Memorial Day Cascades Fireworks Show on May 23, 2026 (Rain Date: May 24), in Jackson.
- M. Special Event Application: Independence Day Cascades Fireworks Show**
Approve a request from Jackson County Parks to host the Independence Day Cascades Fireworks Show on July 3, 2026 (Rain date: July 5), in Jackson.
- N. Special Event Application: Labor Day Cascades Fireworks Show**
Approve a request from Jackson County Parks to host the Labor Day Cascades Fireworks Show on September 5, 2026 (Rain Date: September 6), in Jackson.
- O. Special Event Application: Jackson Annual Juneteenth Celebration**
Approve a request from the Jackson Juneteenth Committee to host the Jackson Annual Juneteenth Celebration on June 20, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- P. Special Event Application: Grand River Farmers Market by Grow Jackson**
Approve a request from Grow Jackson to host the Grand River Farmers Market on Fridays, May 1 - October 30, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- Q. Special Event Application: Recovery Out Loud Walk 2026**
Approve a request from Home of New Vision to host the Recovery Out Loud Walk on September 12, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- R. Special Event Application: Downtown Jackson Artwalks**
Approve a request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority/Art 634 to host the Downtown Jackson Artwalks on April 11, June 13, September 5, and November 28, 2026, in downtown Jackson.

- S. Special Event Application: Gus Macker 3-on-3 Basketball Tournament
Approve a request from the Michigan Sports Facility to host the Gus Macker 3-on-3 Basketball Tournament on May 29-31, 2026, in downtown Jackson.
- T. City of Jackson, Michigan Financial Statements for the Seven Months Ended January 31, 2026
- U. Amendment to the Bylaws of the Downtown Development Authority
Approval of the request from the Jackson Downtown Development Authority (DDA) to amend their bylaws to change its meeting schedule to bi-monthly.
- V. Establish a public hearing date regarding East Washington Avenue, Page Avenue and Elm Avenue (The East Side Commerce Corridor project).
Establish April 21, 2026 at the City Council meeting as the time and place for a presentation and public hearing regarding the East Side Commerce Corridor project for street construction on Page Avenue, E. Washington Avenue and Elm Avenue.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the consent calendar removing Item L for separate consideration. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to approve a request from Jackson County Parks to host the Memorial Day Cascades Fireworks Show on May 23, 2026 (Rain Date: May 24), in Jackson. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Hunt, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Wood (1). Motion carried.

OTHER BUSINESS:

A. Resolution – Special Assessment Roll No. 3454.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to recess as City Council and convene as a Board of Review. Vote was done by voice with all in favor.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the resolution confirming Special Assessment Roll No. 3454. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to adjourn as a Board of Review and reconvene as City Council. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. East Side Economic Development Update

City Manager Jonathan Greene provided Council with an update on the efforts being made to encourage economic development on the City's East Side.

C. Receipt of the Draft 2026-2027 Annual Action Plan for CDBG/HOME Funds

Recommendation: *Receive and place on file the 2026-2027 Annual Action Plan Draft for CDBG/HOME funds.*

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Forgrave to receive and place on file the 2026-2027 Annual Action Plan Draft for CDBG/HOME funds. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

NEW BUSINESS:

A. Ordinance – Water System Revenue Bond

Recommendation: *Adopt the proposed Water System Junior Revenue Bonds, Series 2026 (LTGO) Ordinance taking advantage of the State program allowing the City to make mandated water system improvements and benefit from principal loan forgiveness and lower interest rates.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt the proposed Water System Junior Revenue Bonds, Series 2026 (LTGO) Ordinance taking advantage of the State program allowing the City to make mandated water system improvements and benefit from principal loan forgiveness and lower interest rates. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

B. Resolution - Issuance of Capital Improvement Bonds, Series 2026 (Limited Tax General Obligation)

Recommendation: *Approve the Resolution authorizing the issuance of 2026 Capital Improvement Bonds (Limited Tax General Obligation)*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the Resolution authorizing the issuance of 2026 Capital Improvement Bonds (Limited Tax General Obligation). Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

C. Resolution – Local Bridge Program Funding Application (MDOT)

Recommendation: *Approve a resolution for application to the Michigan Department of Transportation (MDOT) for Local Bridge Program Funding, authorization for the City Clerk to execute the resolution, and authorization for the City Engineer to file an application for the Martin Luther King, Jr. Drive bridge over the Grand River.*

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve a resolution for application to the Michigan Department of Transportation for Local Bridge Program Funding, authorization for the City Clerk to execute the resolution, and authorization for the City Engineer to file an application for the Martin Luther King, Jr. Drive bridge over the Grand River. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

D. Resolution – MDOT Street Decertification

Recommendation: Adopt a resolution to decertify street segments that are ineligible for Act 51 local street funding (portions of Birchwood Drive, Columbus Street, Joy Street, Maplewood Drive and Oakhill Avenue), remove them from the City of Jackson local street network and authorize the City Clerk to sign the attached resolution.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to adopt a resolution to decertify street segments that are ineligible for Act 51 local street funding (portions of Birchwood Drive, Columbus Street, Joy Street, Maplewood Drive and Oakhill Avenue), remove them from the City of Jackson local street network and authorize the City Clerk to sign the attached resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

E. Resolution – MDOT Street Segments Certification

Recommendation: Adopt a resolution to add segments of Orchard Place and Second Street to the City of Jackson Act 51 local street network map that are open for all-day all-year public use and authorize the City Clerk to sign the resolution.

Motion was made by Councilmember Wood, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to adopt a resolution to add segments of Orchard Place and Second Street to the City of Jackson Act 51 local street network map that are open for all-day all-year public use and authorize the City Clerk to sign the resolution. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

F. Contract Award - Street resurfacing on Bloomfield Boulevard from West Avenue to Fourth Street

Recommendation: Approve the award for street resurfacing on Bloomfield Boulevard from West Avenue to Fourth Street to Michigan Paving and Materials, Co., of Grand Rapids, Michigan at a cost of \$195,696.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.

Motion was made by Councilmember Forgrave, seconded by Councilmember Hunt to approve the award for street resurfacing on Bloomfield Boulevard from West Avenue to Fourth Street to Michigan Paving and Materials, Co., of Grand Rapids, Michigan at a cost of \$195,696.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

G. Contract Award – Monkey Run Interceptor Rehabilitation

Recommendation: Approve the award of the Monkey Run Interceptor Rehabilitation contract to LGC Global, Inc. of Detroit, Michigan at a cost of \$1,773,002.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood to approve the award of the Monkey Run Interceptor Rehabilitation contract to LGC Global, Inc. of Detroit, Michigan at a cost of \$1,773,002.00 and authorize the Mayor and City Clerk to execute the appropriate documents. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

H. Contract Change Order – MLK Playground Project

Recommendation: Approve the change order for the MLK Playground Project in the increased amount of \$152,501 to cover additional project costs and necessary modifications to the current contracted playground supplier, Sinclair Recreation of Holland, Michigan.

Motion was made by Councilmember Robinson, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve the change order for the MLK Playground Project in the increased amount of \$152,501 to cover additional project costs and necessary modifications to the current contracted playground supplier, Sinclair Recreation of Holland, Michigan. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

I. Contract Amendment – Interceptor Sewer Rehabilitation Engineering Contract

Recommendation: Approve Amendment 2 to the Interceptor Sewer Rehabilitation Engineering contract with NTH Consultants, Ltd. of Northville, Michigan in the amount of \$225,800.00, and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve Amendment 2 to the Interceptor Sewer Rehabilitation Engineering contract with NTH Consultants, Ltd. of Northville, Michigan in the amount of \$225,800.00, and authorize the City Manager and City Engineer to sign the appropriate document. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

J. Purchase – Lead Service Line Replacement Program Inventory Materials

Recommendation: Approve the purchase of \$200,000.00 in inventory materials by the Public Works Department for the Lead Service Line Replacement program.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Robinson to approve the purchase of \$200,000.00 in inventory materials by the Public Works Department for the Lead Service Line Replacement program. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt, and Forgrave (7). Nays: none. Motion carried.

K. 100 Homes Program – Realtor Commission

Recommendation: Approve a flat-fee commission rate of \$1,500 for any licensed realtor who brings an approved 100 Homes Program buyer to the City, provided said buyer meets all program rules, utilizes approved City supports, and takes ownership of the new home within the prescribed timeline; authorize City staff to make any necessary program guideline adjustments and create any necessary contractual/other paperwork; and authorize the City Manager to execute any related agreements.

Motion was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Gunn to approve a flat-fee commission rate of \$1,500 for any licensed realtor who brings an approved 100 Homes Program buyer to the City, provided said buyer meets all program rules, utilizes approved City supports, and takes ownership of the new home within the prescribed timeline; authorize City staff to make any necessary program guideline adjustments and create any necessary contractual/other paperwork; and authorize the City Manager to execute any related agreements.

Councilmember Wood made a motion to amend by replacing the language “realtor” with the phrase “real estate agent”. No objection was made and the amendment was accepted by unanimous consent.

Councilmember Forgrave made a motion to amend by striking the language “commission rate” from the main motion. No objection was made and the amendment was accepted by unanimous consent.

Vote was taken on the motion as amended, approve a flat-fee of \$1500 for any licensed real estate agent who brings an approved 100 Homes Program buyer to the City, provided said buyer meets all program rules, utilizes approved City supports, and takes ownership of the new home within the prescribed timeline; authorize City staff to make any necessary program guideline adjustments and create any necessary contractual/other paperwork; and authorize the City Manager to execute any related agreements. Vote – Yeas: Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, and Forgrave (6). Nays: Councilmember Hunt (1). Motion carried.

CITY COUNCILMEMBER'S COMMENTS:

Mayor Mahoney, Vice Mayor Dancy, Councilmembers Robinson, Gunn, Wood, Hunt all offered comments.

Councilmember Forgrave declined to offer comments.

Members of Youth Council who were present for the meeting offered comments.

MANAGER'S COMMENTS:

City Manager Jonathan Greene offered comments.

ADJOURNMENT:

No further business being offered, a motion to adjourn was made by Vice Mayor Dancy, seconded by Councilmember Wood. Vote was made by voice with all in favor. Mayor Mahoney adjourned the meeting at 8:05 p.m.